

DOGS **AT** WORK

Dogs do not know they have jobs. They follow scent, movement, instinct, training and reward. The “work” begins when humans turn those natural abilities into value: safer airports, faster searches, healthier people, protected livestock, better science. Dogs are an invisible workforce whose contribution is felt emotionally but rarely counted economically.

TO THE DOG; IT'S A GAME.

Working dogs do not know they have jobs. To a sheepdog, moving livestock is instinct, training and the best game in the world. To a detection dog, finding the scent is a puzzle with a reward at the end. To a medical alert dog, noticing that their human smells wrong is not a shift pattern. It is just what they do.

TO HUMANS, IT'S A JOB.

It only becomes work when humans benefit from it. This series looks at the dogs that help Britain function — the noses at the border, the paws on the hills, the search dogs in the woods, the assistance dogs beside their people, and the bio-detection dogs helping scientists ask whether disease has a smell.

THE PAYMENT; VERY DIFFERENT

They are paid in food, shelter, praise, tennis balls, head strokes and the occasional stolen sausage. But their value is measured in time, safety, independence, science and trust. This is about that hidden workforce, and the question behind every wagging tail: if dogs give us this much, what do we owe them back?



LeARN ABOUT...

MEDICAL

BIO-DETECTION DOGS

THE DOGS TEACHING MEDICINE HOW TO SMELL DISEASE

In 2025, two dogs called Bumper and Peanut sniffed out Parkinson’s disease in a double-blind trial with up to 98% specificity. They are not replacing doctors. They may be doing something stranger: proving disease has a smell, so the machines of the future know what to look for. The dog doesn’t become the machine. The dog invents it.

BUMPER AND PEANUT